North London Girls' Schools' Consortium Group 2: 11+ English Paper 2015

School: The North London Independent Girls' Schools' Consortium Group 2
Subject: English (Part A Reading)
Level: 11+
Time: 45 mins
Type: Past Test Paper
Year in use: 2015

Part A

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Q	Sample Answers	Action
1.	(a) Kester barely nodded to her (b) Because he is afraid of what other might say if they find out he enjoys playing with girls.	
2.	• She can smell it • She can hear seagulls crying.	
3.	It is not crowded and this is the section where they are likely to find fossils.	
4.	• She found it interesting to look at for its colour and pattern • The rock was given to her by Kester	
5.	(a) They met before in Uncle Tom's house. (b) Kester pretended to ignore her because he thought she was with two other girls who he doesn't like.	
6.	Lucy might like ... • having Kester to talk to. From the text, we get the impression that Lucy can be introverted or quiet. I know this because it says "My father says I'm gloomy." This shows that how others interpret Lucy is different to how she is perceived by Kester and she seems to prefer Kester's version. • having a friend whom she can speak openly with. Kester acknowledges that they both find it difficult to talk to others, but this doesn't seem to be a problem between them. • to have a bit of adventure with Kester – They jump down together after Kester's encouragement. Lucy might dislike ... • that Kester is selective about when he chooses to speak to her. In the beginning, Kester pretends to ignore her and we later find out that this is not the first time he has done this. He also ignored her at Uncle Tom's house. • Kester can be insulting, for example, he calls her a nit and says that she is ignorant because she has never heard of an ammonite before. Lucy may not like being mocked by someone who she considers a friend.	

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7.	• the stone provides a distraction from the difficulty she has talking about her family situation. It would appear that this is not an easy topic for conversation and the rock gives her something to focus on while she talks about it. • the stone gives her an excuse to not look at Kester which she may find challenging at this point.
8.	• 'plunging into green tunnels' : This creates an image of a vast and steep hill that is covered in greenery. • 'drowning in growth' : This suggests that there is so much greenery that it is taking over and untameable. • 'like sleepwalkers' : This suggests that the characters' task has become automatic, to the point where they are no longer thinking about it. • 'greedily gathering' : This creates a feeling of excess. It also suggests that the characters may be engaging in the activity for selfish means.
9.	• Kester almost admits being lonely when he says "We can't talk to people. We're kind of all shut up inside ourselves." This shows that, generally speaking, he prefers not to share things with people. • He also chooses to avoid places that may have a lot of people, for example, he makes Lucy take a path that is slightly dangerous instead of going through the caravan site. • Furthermore, his choice of hobby is a solitary task. Collecting fossils doesn't require the company of others. • He also actively avoids lively areas, such as the crowded beach.

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